31 KIRAN MAZUMDAR SHAW, 70

FOUNDER & CHAIRPERSON, BIOCON



HER CURE COMPETENCY

BECAUSE as a first-generation entrepreneur and India's first self-made woman billionaire, Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw steers Biocon, continues to make pioneering contributions in biotechnology and enhances affordable access to therapies for diabetes, cancer and autoimmune diseases

BECAUSE she's also an outspoken voice to be reckoned with on issues of governance and policy—and in citizen activism. After the September 2022 Bengaluru floods, she suggested that the metropolis's famously shambolic civic bodies be penalised for winking at the unregulated boom in illegal structures and the funds thus collected used to create water canals

AT THE VANGUARD She co-founded Immuneel Therapeutics, a clinical stage start-up working to bring the latest cancer treatment to India, with author-oncologist Siddhartha Mukherjee

BECAUSE Meanwhile, Biocon is in the pink of health: net revenue for the third quarter (October-December) in FY23 increased by 36 per cent to Rs 3,020 crore from Rs 2,223 crore in Q3FY22

BECAUSE with Biocon Biologics crossing the $1 bn revenue mark in FY23, biosimilars will be the way ahead for her business. Helping her achieve this will be the company's acquisition of partner Viatris's global biosimilars business for $3 billion in November 2022

Illustration by ROUNAK PATRA